

Dakota Lester

Senior Full Stack .NET Developer | Azure Cloud Specialist | Remote

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior .NET developer with 9+ years of experience building scalable full-stack solutions on Azure. Specializes in C#/.NET Core, SQL Server, and ETL pipelines. Proven track record modernizing legacy systems, reducing operational costs, and delivering cloud-native applications in Agile environments. Currently working fully remote; seeking senior-level remote roles where deep Microsoft stack expertise and Azure DevOps experience drive real business impact.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud & DevOps: Microsoft Azure (IaaS/PaaS, Synapse Analytics, DevOps, Active Directory, VM Management, Monitor, Application Insights), CI/CD Pipelines

Backend: C#, VB.NET, ASP.NET (Webforms, MVC, Core), WinForms, REST APIs, SOAP, EDI, xUnit, NUnit

Data & ETL: SQL Server, T-SQL, SSIS, SSRS, SSAS, Big Data Analytics, ETL/ELT Pipelines

Frontend: HTML5, CSS, JavaScript, TypeScript, JSON

Tools & Methodologies: Git, TFS, Visual Studio, SSMS, Docker, Linux, Agile/Scrum, PowerShell, Python, GitHub Copilot, Claude (AI-assisted development, prompt engineering, code review)

EXPERIENCE

Software Developer II | **Irth Solutions** | Remote

July 2022 – Present

- Architected and maintained Azure DevOps CI/CD pipelines, Git strategies, and VM management — significantly reducing deployment times and improving system reliability across production environments.
- Delivered full-stack solutions in C#/.NET (Webforms, MVC, Core, WinForms), modernizing legacy systems and building scalable REST APIs consumed by internal and external stakeholders.
- Engineered complex SQL Server stored procedures and advanced query optimizations, cutting execution times on high-volume transactional workloads.
- Built end-to-end ETL/ELT pipelines using SSIS, SSRS, and SSAS, enabling real-time analytics and executive-level reporting dashboards.
- Integrated GIS tooling (ESRI ArcGIS, NetTopologySuite) to deliver geospatial intelligence features supporting field operations and business decisions.
- Collaborated cross-functionally in Agile/Scrum teams, contributing to sprint planning, code reviews, and technical documentation for non-technical stakeholders.

Software Developer | **National Air Cargo Holdings** | Orchard Park, NY *July 2018 – June 2022*

- Re-architected the airline payroll system, migrating from Microsoft Access to SQL Server 2016 — saving the company hundreds of thousands of dollars annually in processing costs and errors.
- Designed and implemented ETL solutions and SSIS packages for enterprise data migration and warehousing, improving data reliability and processing speed.
- Established EDI standards and integrations to meet contractual service and operational agreements with airline partners.
- Modernized a suite of legacy applications from Visual Studio 2005 to 2017, significantly reducing maintenance overhead and extending application lifecycle.
- Built and maintained web applications across .NET Webforms, MVC, and Core, delivering scalable internal business tools.
- Developed KPI dashboards and executive reporting tools using SSRS, providing real-time visibility into operational performance.

- Automated scheduled workflows using PowerShell and Python, reducing manual effort and improving process reliability.
- Leveraged Microsoft Azure (IaaS/PaaS, Synapse, DevOps, Active Directory) to build and support scalable cloud infrastructure.

IT Consultant | **Enterprise Infrastructure Services** | Buffalo, NY *August 2015 – June 2018*

- Provided enterprise IT support for 20,000+ end users across desktop software, hardware, and system troubleshooting.
- Administered Active Directory, email/file restores, and enterprise systems to ensure business continuity.
- Managed domain name infrastructure (IPv4, IPv6, MAC addresses, canonical names) to maintain network integrity.
- Authored process documentation that improved knowledge sharing and streamlined IT operations across teams.

Undergraduate Teaching Assistant | **University at Buffalo — CS Dept.** | Buffalo, NY *Aug 2017 – May 2018*

- TA for Intro to Computer Science I (~300 students), covering Java, JavaScript, JSON, and algorithms. Held office hours and supported coursework understanding.

PERSONAL PROJECTS

Cloud Storage Server — React, Node.js, Claude AI *Apr 2026 – May 2026*

- Self-hosted LAN file storage server with drag-and-drop uploads, inline media previews, folder organization, real-time search, and tag filtering. Features an embedded AI chat assistant powered by the Claude API.

BigBirdBot — C#, Discord.NET, SQL Server 2022 *Jan 2021 – May 2026*

- Feature-rich Discord bot built with Discord.NET and C# (.NET 8). Provides a full virtual economy, 13 gambling games, a Tamagotchi-style pet system with 15+ species and breeding, a live stock market ticking every 15 minutes, music playback (YouTube, Spotify, SoundCloud), mini-games, keyword triggers, and general server utilities. 100+ slash commands with per-server data stored in SQL Server 2022.

dakotale.github.io/BigBirdBot

dakotale.github.io — HTML, CSS, JavaScript *Dec 2016 – May 2026*

- Personal portfolio site hosted via GitHub Pages, styled with a retro synthwave aesthetic (CRT scanlines, VT323 terminal typography). Continuously maintained since college as a living resume and design playground.

dakotale.github.io

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

CyberPatriot Mentor — Air Force Association *Oct 2013 – Apr 2014*

- Guided a team of six students across grade levels in solving complex computer security challenges as part of the national CyberPatriot competition.

CyberPatriot Captain — Air Force Association *Oct 2011 – Apr 2013*

- Captained the Frankfort-Schuyler CyberPatriot Team, leading six students through national cybersecurity competitions during junior and senior years of high school.

EDUCATION

B.A.Sc., Computer Science and Engineering — University at Buffalo *2015 – 2018*

B.A.Sc., Computer and Information Sciences — SUNY Polytechnic Institute *2013 – 2015*

HONORS & AWARDS

Congress of the United States Certificate of Merit — Apr 2013

New York State Assembly Certificate of Merit — Assemblyman Anthony J. Brindisi, Apr 2013

Congress of the United States Certificate of Merit — Apr 2012